



GTA V sales top \$1 billion

In just three days!!! That's right. It's opening day sales was pegged at a mindboggling \$800 mn, a world record. <http://dgit.in/19pCGgC>



Meet Intel's Minnowboard

Challenging the \$35 Raspberry Pi, Intel launched a 4.2-inch x86 integrated PC with extensive IO ports, selling at \$199. <http://dgit.in/15cwiNV>

Bazaar

HP EliteBook Revolve 810

No functionality was sacrificed in the making of this laptop. Almost.

The Lenovo ThinkPad Twist now has some company, with the HP EliteBook Revolve 810 arriving in the market as an alternative, ultra-flexible laptop for you to buy.

We must say, the laptop does look very professional and well-built. For starters, the magnesium alloy body gives it an industrial aura and the choice of colour adds to its business-like personality. The chassis is coated with what HP calls the scratch-resistant DuraFinish, and there's a thin layer of rubber on the underside to aid in grip. Happily, this kind of finish is completely matte, which means that you never have to worry about fingerprints and maybe even scratches in the long run. The screen hinge has a stainless steel finish. Because the entire machine is so slim (22.2mm), all ports are placed behind the display. While this is perfectly okay in the tablet mode, as a laptop, this is something that is inconvenient. This is the same design that we saw in the Lenovo ThinkPad Twist as well.

Speaking of the Twist, the 11.6-inch screen on the Revolve 810 also twists one way only, but all the way back to the extent that it can lie on its back over the keyboard in what is sort of a tablet mode. The display isn't removable though, something that we've started to notice on hybrids these days. In the tablet mode, the Revolve 810 feels expectedly heavy and thick, but then again, that is just an additional form-factor at your disposal and we can't blame HP for trying.

The display has its good and bad points – crisp text rendering, excellent brightness levels, adequately rich colour reproduction. On the downside, the screen is highly reflective (probably due to the glossy finish to enable a better touch-screen experience), the whites aren't the best we've seen and the resolution of 1366x768 seems so woeful these days. For machines that cost so much money, it is high time that the displays offered higher resolutions than this.

The keyboard is absolutely brilliant, and is an improvement even over the excellent ones we have seen on the newer HP TouchSmart ultrabooks and the ENVY notebooks. While the palm rest area is just about enough for the small form factors, the key travel and response makes this an excellent keyboard for thrashing out long documents on. Most keyboards on smaller sized machines compromise on the experience with either a cramped layout or not enough key travel, but not this one.



Performance is very much in the same range as the Lenovo Twist, and the flash storage makes a considerable difference in the overall snappiness of the machine. You do need to clean the Windows installation and get rid of all the bloat that comes bundled with it though. A problem that is prevalent among most laptops and an absolute pain in the neck.

The battery life was excellent, but compared to what we're being promised with Haswell these days, it falls a little short. Our battery tests pegged the HP's battery at 190 minutes, but in real world usage, typing documents, some web-browsing, music playback, all at 50% brightness, the EliteBook Revolve offered around 5 hours of backup. Of course, this is nowhere near the 10+ hours that devices like the MacBook Air promise us.

The question about the purpose of such a form factor is something that's still up for debate. Irrespective of how well it's made, there are much better laptops that money can buy. Unless you really want the dual functionality and flexibility, you would be better off with a separate notebook and a tablet, if your budget allows for that. Then there is the question of the screen size - there aren't too many people who would be comfortable with an 11.6-inch display for their office work, particularly when they have to pay ₹90,000 for it! Those who do, will love the no-compromise functionality and the style statement the EliteBook Revolve 810 offers.

Vishal Mathur



Features	75
Performance	80
Build	85
Value	60

Specifications

Processor: Intel Core i5-3437U @ 1.9GHz; **RAM:** 4GB; **Graphics:** Intel HD4000; **Display:** 11.6-inch (1366 x 768 pixels) touchscreen; **Storage:** 128GB SSD; **Connectivity:** 2 USB ports, HDMI out, Ethernet, dock connector; **OS:** Windows 8 (64-bit)

Contact

HP India
Phone: N.A.
Email: <http://www8.hp.com/in/en/contact-hp/contact.html>